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21 July 2025

To Whom It May Concern

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am pleased to write this letter in strong support of Yuming Zhou's application to your PhD program. As his instructor and research advisor, I have had the opportunity to observe his intellectual curiosity, technical rigor, and dedication to advancing AI research. Yuming is an exceptional student with the creativity, perseverance, and analytical depth needed to thrive in a doctoral program.

One of Yuming's standout achievements was his project, Bringing Objects to Life: Two Approaches to Interactive AI-Powered Characters, where he explored innovative methods to animate static objects using AI. His work integrated cutting-edge techniques—including image-to-video generation, 3D modeling, and large language models (LLMs)—to create lifelike, interactive characters. What impressed me most was his relentless effort to refine the systems, balancing automation with precision to achieve compelling results. Among eight students in the research group, Yuming's work was the most sophisticated, reflecting both his technical skill and his passion for pushing boundaries in human-computer interaction.

Beyond research, Yuming excelled in my Machine Learning course, which demands a strong mathematical foundation. Despite its theoretical challenges, he not only mastered the material but also applied it with remarkable insight, earning an A+. His ability to dissect complex concepts—from optimization algorithms to neural network architectures—demonstrates his readiness for advanced research. What sets Yuming apart is his eagerness to dive deeper: he often engaged in discussions beyond coursework, proposing novel ideas that revealed his independent thinking.

Yuming's blend of creativity, technical acumen, and work ethic makes him an outstanding candidate for your program. He is not merely a skilled executor but a budding researcher who asks incisive questions and pursues solutions with tenacity. I have no doubt he will contribute meaningfully to your academic community and produce impactful research in AI. I give him my highest recommendation without reservation.

Should you require further details, please feel free to contact me.

Sincerely Yours,

Nevin L. Zhang